Unit 6 - Q1 - Explain the importance of managing and promoting a positive digital identity

NOTE:

You must include within your explanation that a digital image or footprint can be traced and used by third parties such as employers.

Managing a positive image online is important because the information, photos, comments, and activities a person shares online can create an impression of who you are. and anything that you post can be seen by third parties such as colleges, employers, and government. For example, an employer may look for your social media to decide if you fit the values of that company before deciding to hire you or reject you due to the negative revies that they'll receive if you were to work for them and someone stumbled upon your account with inappropriate images, inappropriate posts, inappropriate stuff. All of this will affect the likelihood of you getting a job.

A positive digital image can help a person build a good reputation both personally and professionally. This is activable by thing before posting anything online, using the appropriate privacy settings and avoiding sharing information that could cause future issues. It is also important to remember that deleting something does not always mean it has completely disappeared as other people may have saved a copped or shared it.

Unit 6 - Q2 - Describe possible employee screening checks that an employer might carry out

NOTE:

Employee screening checks, as a minimum you must cover:

• a Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check (for criminal convictions, cautions etc)

• guilty by association check

• security checks such as terror lists, address checks, and employment verification checks

• credit checks.

Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check

There are 3 types of DBS check

Basic DBS check – pre-employment screening process required for individuals.

Includes

Confirms your ID

Confirms you have the right to work in the UK

Employment history

Criminal record

Standard DBS/ Enhanced DBS

Confirms your ID

Confirms you have the right to work in the UK

Employment history

will reveal both unspent and spent convictions.

Criminal record

guilty by association check

Security checks: Evaluates whether an individual may be restricted from certain roles due to their association with someone who has committed an offense.

security checks such as terror lists, address checks, and employment verification checks

Security checks -> confirmation of identity and trustworthiness in order to mention security.

Terrorism and sanctions list checks -> verifies whether someone is on the **Terrorism watch list**

Address checks -> ensure your address is correct so you can restive letter or so the company know how long it will take someone to get to the branch or HQ

Employment verification checks -> confirms the details that have been provide are true

credit checks -> is an exaltation of someone's financial history

Unit 6 - Q3 - Consider potential consequences of unsatisfactory findings as a result of employer checks

NOTE:

Potential consequences can include, but are not limited to:

• unable to get security clearance (eg BPSS/SC/DV)

• unable to work in particular areas

• unable to work for high profile employers

• requirement to give an explanation of the results (eg non-payment of fine or association with an individual with a criminal record).

Unsatisfactory findings from employer checks can have consequences for both the employee and the employer. Depending on what is discovered, an individual may be unable to obtain security clearance working in certain arears or work for certain employers. The company may also face legal, financial, and reputational consequences.

Security clearance

An uunsatisfactory result may prevent an individual from obtaining the security clearance for certain roles. Example some jobs like working with the government require them to perform BPSS, SC, DV, Criminal Records, CTC, ESC, EDV. If an individual doesn't meet the requirements of the relevant clearance process they may not be allowed to work, there.

Legal action

Companies who fail to conduct background checks can face legal action and up to 5 years in prison if they knowingly hire an illegal worker. For example, hiring someone who doesn't possess the legal right to work in the UK can face fines up to £20,000 per illegal they have hired or if that company knowingly hired an illegal individual can face up to 5 years in prison.

Financial loss

Unsatisfactory findings can lead to theft or embezzlement if an employee has a criminal history that they haven't disclose. Poor hiring may lead to poor performance, loss productivity and loss of clints.

Reputational loss

Individuals with falsified qualifications, criminal history or other undisclosed background can cause a sharp drop in reputation. Due to which clints may leave the company for one that hasn't suffer a scandal caused by bad press.

Level	Full name	What it's generally used for
BPSS	Baseline Personnel Security Standard	Basic pre-employment screening for people with access to government assets. **Not technically a security clearance.**
AC	Accreditation Check	Particularly aviation roles involving secure/restricted airport areas.
CTC	Counter Terrorist Check	Roles involving proximity to people/sites considered particularly at risk from terrorism or access to information valuable to terrorists.

Level 1B (L1B)	Level 1B	Current level associated with certain counterterrorism/security-sensitive roles; introduced as part of the newer vetting structure.
SC	Security Check	Common clearance for roles requiring regular, uncontrolled access to **SECRET** material and occasional access to **TOP SECRET** material.
eSC	Enhanced Security Check	Additional assurance above SC but below DV, for specific roles.
DV	Developed Vetting	High-level vetting for roles requiring frequent and uncontrolled access to **TOP SECRET** material or similarly sensitive assets.
eDV	Enhanced Developed Vetting	Additional assurance above DV, used only for a very small number of specifically agreed roles.

Unit 6 - Q4 - Describe the following security clearance levels:

• BPSS (Baseline Personnel Security Standard)

• SC (Security Checked)

• DV (Developed Vetting)

NOTE: You must describe each of the security clearance levels including when they are used.

Baseline Personnel Security Standard -> Basic pre-employment screening for people with access to government assets. for example, after getting a job at a company

Security Checked -> access to SECRET material and occasional access to TOP SECRET material.

For example, working on a project like a jet engine

Developed Vetting -> Additional assurance above DV, used only for a very small number of specifically agreed roles. For example, working in the military

Unit 6 - Q5 - Explain how bias can influence cyber security

Bias influences cyber security by distorted human judgment allowing for social engineering attacks and causing IT staff to make flawed decisions such as misdiagnosis of threat and increasing vulnerability.

Unit 6 - Q6 - Describe the benefits of a security by design mindset

A security by design mind set reduces vulnerabilities, lower remediation cost, strength customer trust, improves compliance, and create more resilient systems by embedding security into the architecture from the start.

Benefits: Fewer vulnerabilities and lower remediation cost:

Security flaws caught during design are cheaper to fix then those discovered after deployment.

Easer threat madling and secure architecture decisions prevent system weakness.

Unit 6 - Q7 - Identify skills required for a career in cyber security

The key skills for cybersecurity professionals are Networking, Code, Communication, Teamwork, Problem-solving, and an understanding of computer hardware and systems. Networking is important because cybersecurity professionals need to understand how devices communicate with each other and how networks can be attacked or protected. Coding is also useful because some cyber security roles require professionals to understand programming languages, write scripts, automate tasks, analyses malicious code, or identify vulnerabilities in software.

Communications skills are important because cybersecurity professionals need to explain technical problems and security risk to both technical and non-technical people. Teamwork is important because cybersecurity incidents are often delt within teams of people who have different responsibilities and areas of expertise. Problem-solving and analytical skills are needed to investigate suspicious activity, identify the cause of security incidents, find vulnerabilities, and decide how they should be fixed.

A cyber security professional should also understand computer systems, hardware, operating systems, databases, cloud services, and other technologies because these are commonly involved in cyber security incidents. It is also useful to understand the different roles available within the cyber security sector, such as security analyst, penetration tester, security engineer, incident responder, security consultant, and security manager, because each role has different responsibilities and requires different skills.

Finally, it is important to understand what qualifications, training, and experience are required for the career path you want to follow. Knowing which area of cyber security, you want to work in can help you choose the right qualifications and practical experience instead of spending unnecessary time and money on training that may not be relevant to your chosen career. Cyber security is also constantly changing, so professionals need to be willing to continue learning and developing their skills throughout their careers. Just to list a few.

Unit 6 - Q8 -Perform a personal skills analysis

NOTE:

You must carry out an analysis of your skills. You could rate and rank your skills, utilise feedback from others, use an approach such as a SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats) or SOAR (Strengths, Opportunities, Aspirations, Results) analysis.

Strengths

One of my strengths is that I have practical IT and telecommunications skills. I have experience with networking, structured cabling, fibre installation and troubleshooting. I also have good problem-solving skills and try to use a logical approach when dealing with technical problems. I am willing to learn new skills and improve the knowledge I already have. I also work well with other people when solving problems and I am persistent when dealing with difficult technical tasks.

Weaknesses

One of my weaknesses is communication and talking, especially when I am speaking to people I do not know. I can lack confidence when explaining technical information verbally. I also have limited experience in some areas of IT, especially more advanced technical subjects. Coding can be difficult for me to learn independently, so I may need additional guidance and practice to improve. Another weakness is that I need to improve my confidence when answering questions under pressure.

Opportunities

There are several opportunities I can use to improve my skills. I can gain further qualifications and certifications in IT and networking and develop my IT operations and troubleshooting skills through practical experience. I can also improve my communication skills through teamwork, presentations and workplace experience. Another opportunity is to learn more about coding and scripting, such as Python or PowerShell. I could also gain experience working with experienced IT professionals and learn from them. Using online courses, tutorials and practical labs would help me develop my technical knowledge. Regularly practising technical problems and explaining my solutions to other people would also help me build my confidence.

Aspirations

My main aspiration is to build a successful career in IT operations. I want to become more confident at troubleshooting and resolving a wide range of IT problems. I also want to develop strong knowledge of networking, systems and infrastructure while improving my communication and teamwork skills. I want to continue gaining qualifications and professional experience so that I can eventually progress into a more senior IT role with greater responsibility. I would like to become someone who can confidently investigate problems, find solutions and support other users.

Unit 6 - Q9 - Assess own skills against those required for a career in cyber security

My Current skills provide a good foundation for a career in cyber security particularly because I already have experience in IT, Telecommunications, structured cabling, fiber installation, and troubleshooting. Understanding networking is important in cyber security because many cyber-attacks involve networks, connected devices, or communication between systems. My experience troubleshooting technical problems also gives me a useful starting point because cyber security requires people to investigate problems logically and identify possible causes.

One of my strengths is problem-solving. I tend to approach technical problems logically and persist when trying to find a solution. This is relevant to cyber security because security professionals need to investigate suspicious activity, identify vulnerabilities, analyse incidents, and find ways to protect systems. I am also willing to learn new skills and improve my existing knowledge, which is important because cyber security is constantly changing and requires professionals to continue learning.

I also have some teamwork skills, which are useful because cyber security professionals often work with other IT and security staff to investigate and resolve incidents. However, my communication skills are an area that I need to improve. I can find it difficult to communicate with unfamiliar people and I lack confidence when explaining technical information verbally. Communication is important in cyber security because professionals need to explain security risks, report incidents, document findings, and communicate with technical and non-technical users.

Another area I need to develop is my coding and scripting knowledge. Coding can currently be difficult for me to learn independently, and I may need additional guidance and practical practice. Programming is not required to the same level for every cyber security role, but understanding scripting and programming languages such as Python or PowerShell can be useful for automation, analysing data, security testing, and managing systems. I therefore need to improve these skills if I want to progress further into cyber security.

I also have limited experience with some more advanced areas of IT and cyber security, so I would need to develop my knowledge of subjects such as operating systems, security tools, vulnerabilities, threat detection, incident response, and cyber security principles. Gaining qualifications, completing practical labs, and learning from experienced IT and cyber security professionals would help me develop these areas.

Overall, I believe I currently have a good technical foundation but still need further development before I would be fully prepared for a cyber security career. My strongest areas are networking, practical IT, troubleshooting, problem-solving, teamwork, and my willingness to learn. My main development areas are communication, confidence, coding, and scripting, and knowledge of more advanced cyber security technologies and techniques. By gaining further qualifications, completing practical cyber security labs, practicing coding, and developing my communication skills, I can improve my suitability for a career in cyber security and work towards progressing into a specialist or senior IT/security role.

Unit 6 - Q10 - Create a personal development plan

NOTE:

You must create a personal development plan to address the areas for development identified within the personal skills analysis in question 8 and question 9, this must include SMART targets.

Areas for improvement	Activities	SMART Target	Lenth of Time	EVIDENCE OF ATCHIVMENT
IT & Networking info	Study networking things like: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP & other stuff like hardware. Using free info from YouTube	I'll improve my knowledge by completing 3 networking study session	completing in 3months	Course completion records, notes, completed exercises and improved performance in practical tasks.
Cybersecurity info	Study CompTIA security+ using free online recourse	Complete a structured study program covering all the major security+ SY0-701 and active at least 80 percent before doing the actual exam	6 months	Practice-test results, revision notes and completed study materials.
Coding	Follow beginner programming tutorials & complete small projects	I'll complete 3 projects and practice for 2 hours for 3 months	3 months	Completed programs/projects, code files and a record of weekly practice.
Industry knowledge and CPD	Read IT industry publications, participate in online IT communities, attend relevant events where possible and complete online learning. Read IT industry publications, participate in online IT communities, attend relevant events where possible and complete online learning.	I will complete at least one CPD activity every **month** and record what I have learned and how it could improve my skills.	Over the next 6 months	CPD log, certificates, notes and records of activities completed.

Unit 6 - Q11 - Explain the term continuous professional development (CPD)

CPD is the process of continuous learning, improving, and developing your own skills and knowledge, and experience throughout their career it involves identifying our own weakness so you can improve them and become better and be more competent. For example, an IT person could attend course, read about improvements, practice, and record what improvements were made. This helps them keep their knowledge UpToDate as technology keeps changing and improving.

Unit 6 - Q12 - State methods of keeping up to date with industry knowledge

To say up to date you can read industry publications, engage with Socal media, participate in online communities, attending industry events, complete training, follow professional organisations, watch videos.

For example, an IT professional could follow professional organisations, read industry publications and participate in IT communities to keep their knowledge up to date.

Unit 6 - Q13 - Explain why it is important to keep CPD up to date

CPD is for professional to keep their skills knowledge up to date which is critical for maintaining competence and proficiency in their field. Helps professional stay relevant in the industry adapt to change in work environment and demonstrate their commitment to self-improvement.